

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

04 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Crime Paralegal role at G2 Legal's Hounslow office because criminal defence work sits close to the kind of public-facing, procedurally demanding legal work I have been building toward, and my background supporting litigation and advising clients on complex legal matters gives me a practical foundation to contribute from day one.

At BCLP, I spent six months in International Arbitration and six months in Real Estate Disputes, working on live matters with real procedural stakes. In arbitration, I became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. I organised the document set, tracked outstanding actions across the matter, and helped ensure on-time delivery of the Claimant's memorial. That experience gave me a clear understanding of what it means to manage a case file under pressure, and the feedback from the partner and associate was that my work was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. In Real Estate Disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, and handled court filings across several matters running at the same time with competing deadlines.

Outside private practice, I have spent the past year as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where most of my caseload involves clients who are vulnerable or in difficult circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, identify the relevant legal and evidential issues, draft correspondence and applications, and manage cases from first interview through to submission. Advising people on procedural requirements in plain, accessible language has become a significant part of what I do, and I have found that work genuinely rewarding. Criminal defence clients will often be in stressful and high-stakes situations, and I am comfortable working sensitively in that environment.

I want to work in criminal litigation specifically because the procedural discipline, client communication and preparation work that I have found most engaging in my experience so far are all central to it. This role at a firm with a stable, long-established crime team and a commitment to staff development is a sensible and genuinely appealing next step for me. I would bring careful file management, solid research skills, and direct client-facing experience to the team from the start.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva